



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

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— Tantravārttika, \$6M898M23G Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Tantravārttika here delves into the nature of understanding and how meaning arises, particularly in the context of Vedic rituals. Consider how a young student, upon seeing smoke, infers the presence of fire. The verse states that from the perception of something marked by fire, like smoke tinged with a reddish hue, the child's intellect grasps the presence of fire through similarity. This highlights the power of analogy and the reliance on perceived resemblances in your learning process.

The passage then moves to critique the idea that something can be inherently connected to every action. It argues that it is impossible for one single thing to be associated with every action because of inherent contradictions. For example, the *yajamana*, the one performing the sacrifice, and the *prastara*, a bundle of sacred grass, cannot both be the direct cause of everything, because their roles are distinct and sometimes even contradictory. The scripture implies that if you try to make one single thing the cause of everything, it leads to absurdity.

Further, the verses explore the issue of wholeness and parts. If a word refers to a whole, you cannot simply apply it to a part. For instance, if the word "hundred" is used, you cannot take it to mean "fifty" in its primary sense. It underscores that the meaning of a whole cannot be derived piecemeal from its components without considering the larger context.

In modern life, this wisdom speaks to the way you interpret information and make decisions. Be mindful of the analogies you use, ensuring they hold true. Don't fall into the trap of oversimplifying complex situations by attributing everything to a single cause. Remember to consider the full context before drawing conclusions and avoid fragmenting meaning. The verses are a call to integrity in thought and action, urging you to embrace a holistic perspective.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you attributing complex problems to singular causes, and how can you expand your perspective to see the bigger picture?